

## 2.3 The stages at Import

In general, there are seven distinct stages in the import process by sea or air:

1. Advance provision of safety and security data.
2. Report of arrival of the means of transport.
3. Presentation of goods.
4. Temporary storage.
5. Declaration of goods.
6. Examination of goods.
7. Release of goods.

### 2.3.1 Advance provision of safety and security data

All ships and aircraft carrying non-Union goods into the customs territory of the Union are required to provide specific details in advance of their arrival. This is done by submitting an Entry Summary Declaration to customs at the first port or airport of entry. Full details of the requirement in this regard are contained in [Section 3](#) of this manual.

### 2.3.2 Report of arrival of the means of transport

[Sections 4](#) and [5](#) of this manual contain specific details of the procedures governing importation by sea and air respectively including the reporting requirements relating to each.

### 2.3.3 Customs Roll-on Roll-off Service

Goods moving to or from the United Kingdom (excluding Northern Ireland) are subject to customs formalities since 1 January 2021.

Revenue's Customs Roll-On Roll-Off Service (RoRo Service) facilitates the movement and control of goods and vehicles when moved by scheduled ferry between Ireland and Great Britain. There is more information on [RoRo](#) on the Revenue website.

### 2.3.4 Presentation of goods (Article 139 UCC)

Apart from the reporting requirement for the ship or aircraft carrying cargo, it is important to note that the goods being imported from a non-Union country must be presented to Revenue by the person who brought them into the Union or the person who assumes responsibility for their onward carriage.

Article 182 of the UCC refers to the possibility that customs authorities may, upon application, authorise a person to lodge a customs declaration, including a simplified